JAMES RICHARDSON

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I'm a DevOps engineer with 6 years of hands-on experience building and maintaining infrastructure for high-traffic applications. I started my career managing on-premises servers and have spent the last four years working almost exclusively with Kubernetes and cloud platforms. I've got a strong track record of reducing deployment times and improving system reliability, and I genuinely enjoy mentoring junior engineers through complex troubleshooting scenarios.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Senior DevOps Engineer

Vertex Cloud Solutions

vertexcloud.io

Manchester, United Kingdom

March 2022 - Present

Designed and implemented a fully containerized microservices architecture supporting 40+ applications running on Kubernetes clusters across AWS and on-premises data centers, reducing deployment time from 2 hours to 8 minutes for standard releases

Established comprehensive Infrastructure as Code practices using Terraform and Ansible, enabling the team to manage 200+ cloud resources and bringing infrastructure change cycle time down from weeks to days

Mentored three junior DevOps engineers on CI/CD pipeline design, Prometheus monitoring, and incident response procedures, with all three receiving promotions within 18 months

Implemented automated disaster recovery procedures and conducted quarterly failover drills, achieving 99.95% uptime SLA across all production systems

DevOps Engineer

Pinnacle Digital Services Ltd

pinnacle-digital.co.net

Leeds, United Kingdom

July 2019 - February 2022

Built and maintained Jenkins CI/CD pipelines for 15 development teams using Groovy and Python, enabling developers to deploy code to staging environments within 10 minutes of merge requests

Migrated legacy monolithic applications to AWS using Docker and ECS, reducing infrastructure costs by 35% and improving application response times by an average of 200ms

Implemented centralized logging and monitoring using ELK Stack and Datadog across 50+ virtual machines and containerized applications, reducing mean time to detection for critical issues from 45 minutes to 8 minutes

Automated routine operational tasks through custom Python scripts and Bash automation, eliminating approximately 20 hours of manual work per week across the operations team

DevOps Engineer

BT plc

bt.com

Manchester, United Kingdom

September 2018 - June 2019

Supported production Linux servers hosting customer-facing applications, managing system patches, performance tuning, and security compliance across 80+ physical and virtual machines

Designed and deployed automated backup solutions using Veeam and shell scripts, achieving a recovery time objective of under 4 hours for all critical systems

Collaborated with network engineering teams to troubleshoot connectivity issues and optimize application performance across distributed data centers

Implemented Nagios monitoring infrastructure and created custom alerting rules, improving visibility into system health and reducing unplanned downtime incidents by 25%

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

University of Manchester

Manchester, United Kingdom

Graduated: June 2018

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Cloud Platforms: AWS (EC2, S3, RDS, Lambda, CloudFormation), Azure (Virtual Machines, App Service)

Container Orchestration: Kubernetes, Docker, Docker Compose, Helm

Infrastructure as Code: Terraform, Ansible, CloudFormation

CI/CD: Jenkins, GitLab CI, GitHub Actions

Monitoring and Logging: Prometheus, Grafana, ELK Stack, Datadog, New Relic

Version Control: Git, GitHub, GitLab

Scripting and Programming: Python, Bash, Groovy

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB

Web Servers: Nginx, Apache

Linux Distributions: Ubuntu, CentOS, Red Hat Enterprise Linux